Installing ActionCable

Installing ActionCable has already been done as part of our generic Rails setup. The Ruby gem is a dependency of Rails, so it is part of our Gemfile.lock. We need to add the the JavaScript package to our package.json file, along with the associated TypeScript definitions with yarn add @rails/actioncable @types/rails__actioncable. We'll have a couple of other bits we need to do when we start generating our own ActionCable channels.

ActionCable has some configuration that you can see in the config/cable.yml file:

chapter_09/01/config/cable.yml

```
development:
  adapter: redis
  url: redis://localhost:6379/1

test:
  adapter: test

production:
  adapter: redis
  url: <%= ENV.fetch("REDIS_URL") { "redis://localhost:6379/1" } %>
  channel_prefix: north_by_seven_production
```

ActionCable typically runs in the background, out of band from the user's HTTP requests, so that ActionCable broadcasts don't delay the server responses. Hotwire changes the ActionCable default so that the development environment uses Redis,[68] an in-memory data storage tool, to manage background processing. (The non-Hotwire development default is to just fake background processing and do processes in band.)

The easiest way to install Redis in your development environment is via Docker. If you are comfortable with Docker, you can just run the following command: docker run --rm -it -p 6379:6379 redis:latest, and it will run a standard Redis image that communicates on the expected port and will work for our development purposes.